More Journals on Easter Island:

The works of Johann Reinhold Forster (1729-1798) and Johann George Adam Forster (1754-1794) [Part II]

Herbert von Saher

The Forsters' journal continues with the following excerpts taken from the chapter on Easter Island:

"On the 13th, early in the morning, we ran close to the south point of the island, where the shore rose perpendicularly and consisted of broken rocks....two detached rocks lay about a quarter of a mile off this pont; one of them was singular on account of its shape, resembling a huge column or obelisk, and both were the habitations of numerous sea fowls which stunned our ears with their discordant screams. Soon after we opened another point about ten miles distant and as we advanced we perceived the ground gently sloping to the sea. On the slope we discovered several plantations...but the surface of the isle in general appeared to be extremely dreary and parched, and these plantations were so thinly scattered upon it that they did not flatter our hopes of meeting with considerable refreshments.....we distinguished a number of people nearly naked, hastily running down from the hills towards the sea-side....In a few minutes we saw them launch a canoe, in which two men came off towards us. They were along side in a short time...and immediately called out for a rope, naming it by the same word as the Taheitians. We had no sooner thrown them the rope, than they tied a great cluster of ripe bananas to it, making signs for us to haul it up. The sudden emotions of joy in every countenance at the sight of this fruit are scarcely to be described.... "

Cook tied some medals and beads to some ribbons and gave them in return; the islanders fastened a small piece of barkcloth to a fishing line; this appeared to be made of the same bark as used in Tahiti. The Forsters immediately concluded the language to be dialect of Tahitian, and they noted that this language "...had now [been] found in both extremities of the South Seas." The tattoo markings and extended ear lobes were remarked upon: "They had punctures of the same nature with those used by natives of the Society and Friendly Islands and of New Zealand; but their whole body, which was perfectly naked, was marked with them. The greatest singularity which we observed about them was the size of their ears, of which the lap or extremity was stretched out so as almost to rest on the shoulder, and pierced by a very large hole, through four or five fingers might be thrust with ease."

The ships ran along the coast searching for a good anchorage, but finding none, returned to the place where the canoe had put off. They already were noticing the statues: "A great number of black pillars stood along the shore, many of which were elevated on platforms consisting of several ranges of stone. We could now distinguish something resembling a human head and shoulders....Sometimes we perceived two, sometimes four, and even five together in a row; but some were likewise placed by themselves. We saw but few plantations towards the north end, the land being much more bluff or steep there, than about the middle of the island, and we could easily perceive that there was not a tree upon the whole island, which exceeded the height of ten feet. "

Hoisting a boat for soundings caused the natives to assemble along the coast, and a crowd of men could be seen; some were dressed in a bright yellow or orange cloth. Most, however, were naked and it was assumed those wearing robes were principal people. Houses could be seen from the boat: "...extremely low and long, highest in the middle, and sloping down towards both extremities. They much resembled a canoe turned with the keel or bottom upwards. In the middle there seemed to be a small entrance or door, which was so low that a man of common size must stoop to get in."

One bold islander returned to the ship with the boat; Forster describes him as: "...about five feet eight inches high, and remarkably hairy on the breast and all over the body. His colour was a chestnut brown, his beard strong, but clipped short, and of a black colour as was also the hair of his head, which was likewise cut short. His ears were very long, almost hanging on his shoulders, and his legs punctured in compartments after a taste which we had observed no where else. He had only a belt around the middle, from whence a kind of net-work descended before, too thin to conceal anything from the sight. A string was tied around his neck, and a flat bone, something shaped like a tongue, and about five inches long, was fastened to it, and hung down on the breast. This, he told us, was a porpoise's bone (*eevee toharra*), expressing it exactly by the same words which a Taheitian would have made use of. To explain himself better, he also called it *eevee-eeka*, which we understood to signify the bone of a fish."

The islander spent the night on the *Resolution*, wrapped in some cloth from Tahiti, given him by Johann Forster. Mahine, the Tahitian native travelling on the ship, was pleased to find inhabitants who spoke a language similar to his own.

George's narrative continues the following day: "We dragged our anchor during the night...so we were obliged to set sail again in order to recover our situation. Immediately after breakfast, Captain Cook went ashore with the native, whose name was Maroowahai, together with Mahine, my father, Dr. Sparrman, and myself, though my feet and legs were still swelled excessively and I was hardly able to walk....About a hundred, or hundred and fifty natives were assembled on the spot where we landed, almost all of them naked, some having only a belt round

the middle....A very few of them had a cloak which reached to the knees, made of cloth, resembling that of

The now-famous etching by Cook's artist shows an Easter Islander with elongated ear-lobes.

Taheitee in the texture, and stitched or quilted with thread to make it the more lasting. Most of these cloaks were painted yellow with turmeric root. The people did not make the least unfriendly motion at our landing, but expressed a prodigious dread of our fire-arms, of which they seemed to know the deadly effects. We saw but few arms among them; some however had lances or spears, made of thin ill-shapen sticks, and pointed with a sharp triangular piece of black glassy lava.....One of them had a fighting club, made of a thick piece of wood about three feet long, carved at one extremity; and a few others had short wooden clubs, exactly resembling some of the New Zealand *patoo-patoos,* which are made of bone. We observed some who had European hats and caps, chequered cotton handkerchiefs, and ragged jackets of blue woollen-cloth, which were so many indubitable testimonies of the visit which the Spanish had made to this island in 1770....

"Their want of clothing and a great eagerness to obtain our goods without offering anything in return, seems altogether to be sufficient marks of poverty. They were all prodigiously punctured on every part of the body, the face in particular; and their women, who were very small and slender limbed, had likewise punctures on the face....The number of women in the crowd did not exceed ten or twelve; they were seldom satisfied with their natural clear brown colour but painted the whole face with a reddish brown ruddle, over which they laid on the bright orange of the turmeric root or ornamented themselves with elegant streaks of white shell-lime." As for head coverings, "...most of the men wore a ring about two inches thick, strongly and curiously plaited, of grass and sitting close round the head. This was covered with great quantities of the long black feathers which decorate the neck of the man-of-war bird. Others had huge bunchy caps of brown gull feathers, which were almost as large as the full-bottomed wigs of European lawyers; and still others wore a simple hoop of wood, round which a number of the long white feathers of a gannet hung nodding, and waved in the wind. The women wore a great wide cap, made of very neat mat-work; it was pointed forwards, formed a ridge along the top; and two large lobes behind on each side, which we found extremely cooling for the head....The only ornaments which we saw among them were the flat pieces of bone in the shape of a tongue, or like a laurel leaf, which both sexes wore hanging on their breast, together with some necklaces and ear-jewels made of shells."

Cook and his small group began a walk into the island, noting the barren and rocky land: "About fifteen yards from the landing place we saw a perpendicular wall of square hewn stones, about a foot and a half or two feet long, and one foot broad. Its greatest height was about seven or eight feet, but it gradually sloped on both sides, and its length might be about 20 yards. A remarkable circumstance was the junction of these stones, which were laid after the most excellent rules of art, sitting in such manner as to make a durable piece of architecture....The ground rose from the water's side upwards; so that another wall, parallel to the first, about 12 yards from it and facing the country, was not above two or three feet high. The whole area...was filled up with soil and covered with grass. About fifty yards farther to the south there was another elevated area, of which the surface was paved with square stones exactly similar to those which formed the walls. In the midst of this area, there was a pillar consisting of a single stone, which represented a human figure to the waist, about twenty feet high, and upwards of five feet wide....On the top of the head a huge round cylinder of stone was placed upright, being above five feet in diameter and in height. "

As the small group walked further and with difficulty over the rough stony ground (noting how easily the natives skipped from stone to stone!) Forster observed shrubbery and identified various plants common also in Tahiti: the paper mulberry, hibiscus, mimosa, and *solanum*.They had a closer look at the typical boat-shaped house: "The foundation consisted of stones about a foot long, laid level with the surface in two curved lines, converging at the extremities. These lines were about six feet asunder in the middle but not above one foot at the ends. In every stone of this foundation we observed one or two holes in each of which a stake was inserted. The middlemost stakes were six feet high, but the others gradually diminished to two

feet. On the top, the stakes all converged and were tied by strings....A kind of thatch, made of small sticks, and covered with neat mat-work of sugar cane leaves, leaned on each row of stakes, forming a very sharp ridge or angle at the top....A hole was left on one side, about 18 inches or two feet high over which the people had built a round projecting funnel to keep off the wet. We crept on all fours into this opening and found the inside of the hut perfectly naked and empty, there being not so much as a wisp of straw to lie down upon...."

Forster comments on the dearth of occupation houses and concluded that they must either be crammed full or they were used for chiefs with the commoners sleeping in the open. He also observed openings that led underground and thought it likely that people sought shelter underground in natural caverns; however, they were prevented by the natives from entering the caves.

Near the boat-shaped house, they observed a sugar cane plantation and one of bananas; the bananas were growing in holes one foot deep, which they accurately supposed was contrived for collecting rain. Forster was impressed by the sugar cane which was growing about nine or ten feet high and, as it was offered in place of water to drink, they concluded that the island lacked water. However, coming back to the landing place they met up with Cook: "...the natives had conducted [Cook] to a well very close to the sea which was cut deep into the rock, but full of impurities. When our people cleared it, they found the water in it rather brackish but the natives drank of it with much seeming satisfaction."

Cook had had little success trading for provisions, and concluded the people had very little to spare: "A few matted baskets full of sweet potatoes, some sugar-canes, bunches of bananas, and two or three small fowls ready dressed, were the whole purchase which he had made for a few iron tools, and some Taheitee cloth. He had presented the people with beads, but they always threw them away with contempt, as far as ever they could. Whatever else they saw about us, they were desirous of possessing, though they had nothing to give in return. Their number was now decreased nearly to one half, many of them having probably gone home to their dinners; however, the number of women was always remarkably small in proportion to the men, there not being above twelve or fifteen at our first landing, and about six or seven when we embarked again. They were neither reserved nor chaste, and for the trifling consideration of a small piece of cloth, some of our sailors obtained the gratification of their desires. "

They returned to land again in the afternoon while one boat went to fetch water at the well, and encountered an islander who seemed to have some authority and who accompanied the Captain: "He was not so timorous as the rest of his countrymen, but walked boldly along with us, whilst the others were alarmed at the least motion which appeared unusual to them. This disposition, however, did not prevent them from picking our pockets, or stealing anything which suited them. We had not been half an hour on shore when one of them came behind Mahine and very nimbly snatching a black cap from his head, ran off with the greatest velocity over the heaps of rugged stones....Mahine was so surprised that it was some time before he could find words to complain...and when he did, the thief was already at a great distance.About the same time...one of the natives ran off with [Mr. Hodges'] hat in the same manner. Mr. Wales was standing by him with a musket in his hand, but very justly reflected that so slight a crime did not deserve the punishment of a leaden bullet."

In their walk along the shore, noting plants and the dearth of animals, Forster again remarks upon the great correspondence between the features, customs, and languages with natives in other South Sea islands. They diligently searched for anything other than the common fowl--but in vain. But they did note "...two or three noddies, which were so tame as to settle on the shoulders of the natives, but from these individuals we could not conclude that they kept a regular breed of them."

At sun set, on their way back to the boat, they passed by the single statue, and asked questions about the nature of these stones: "...from what we could understand, we concluded that they were monuments erected to the memory of some of their *areekees*, or kings. This led us to believe that the pedestal was perhaps to be considered as burying place and on looking carefully around it, we found a number of human bones, which confirmed our conjecture....To the westward of the cove there was a range of three pillars standing on a very large elevated area or pedestal. This range the natives distinguished by the name of *hanga-roa*, and the single pillar they called *obeena*....."

The next morning, Cook appointed a party of marines and sailors under the command of Lieutenants Pickersgill and Edgecumbe, to reconnoiter the interior parts of the island to see if any other part was better cultivated or more heavily inhabited. With them went Hodges, Sparrman and Johann Forster. George went with Cook and several officers and upon landing found about 200 inhabitants assembled--but only 14 or 15 of them women. Walking into the countryside, they found the heat "violent" and bemoaned the lack of shade. Some had brought guns in the hope of shooting some game but found nothing. Wandering through fields they saw no evidence for garden enclosures of the type described by Roggeveen, and complained of the exhausting heat.

Returning to the landing place, they found Cook still occupied in trading: "The most valuable article of trade on our part were empty coconut shells, which we had received at the Society and Friendly Islands; but they were not

current, unless the hole in them was very small, or unless they had a cover. The Taheitian and European cloths were valued in the next degree, according to the size of the pieces; and iron-ware bore an inferior price. The greatest part of the natives who traded with us instantly ran off with the cloth, nut-shell, or the nail...as if they were apprehensive that we might repent of our bargain, even though they dealt honestly with us. Some of them were bold enough to run off with what they had received...before they had delivered up the goods for which we had bargained. From such circumstances the deplorable condition of the natives became more and more conspicuous. The scarcity of cloth among them was extremely great, most of the people being forced to go naked; but this did not prevent their selling what little cloth they had in exchange for that of Taheitee. The desire of possessing this cloth prompted them to expose to sale several articles which perhaps they would have not parted with so easily under other circumstances. Among these were their different caps or headdresses, their necklaces, ornaments for the ear, and several human figures, made of narrow pieces of wood about 18 inches or two feet long, and wrought in a much neater and more proportionate manner than we could have expected, after seeing the rude sculpture of the statues. They were made to represent persons of both sexes; the features were not very pleasing, and the whole figure was much too long to be natural; however, there was something characteristic in them, which shewed a taste for the arts. The wood of which they were made was finely polished, close-grained, and of a dark-brown, like that of the *casuarina*. But as we had not yet seen this tree growing here, we eagerly expected the return of our party, hoping they would make some discoveries to explain this circumstance. Mahine was most pleased with these carved human figures, the workman of which much excelled those of the *e Tees* in his country, and he purchased several of them assuring us they would be greatly valued at Taheitee. As he took great pains to collect these curiosities, he once met with a woman's hand, carved of yellowish wood, nearly of natural size.....its fingers were all bent upwards, as they are in the action of dancing at Taheitee, and its nails were represented very long, extending at least 3/4 of an inch beyond the fingers' end. The wood of which it was made was the rare perfume-wood of Taheitee....Mahine afterwards presented this piece to my father, who has in his turn made a present of it to the British Museum. "

Returning to the *Resolution*, George observed a few natives who had swum to the ship, although it was about 3/4 of a mile off shore: "They expressed the most unbounded admiration at everything they saw, and every one of them measured the whole length of the vessel from head to stern, with his extended arms; such a great quantity of timber of so stupendous a size being altogether incomprehensible to people whose canoes were patched of many small bits of wood. Among them was one woman who....carried on a particular traffic of her own."

George Forster's conclusion as the result of his interactions with the Easter Islanders was that: "Their behavior towards me was wholly inoffensive, agreeably to the general character of the nations of the South Seas. From the expressions of the historians of Roggewein's voyage, it should seem that the Dutch very wantonly fired upon the natives, who gave no provocation, and killed a considerable number of them, intimidating the rest to a great degree. It is probably that the terror with which they looked upon the destructive arms of Europeans at that time, and during the last visit of the Spaniards, was revived among them at our appearance, and had an influence on their general timid behavior towards us; but it is not to be doubted, at the same time, that there is a mildness, fellow-feeling and good nature in their disposition which naturally prompts them to treat their visitors kindly and even hospitably, as far as their wretched country will permit."

At this point in the narrative, George inserts notes made by his father, who had gone off in exploring another direction: "Immediately after landing, we walked directly inland or across the country, under the highest hill which lies toward the south, till we came to the other side of the island. About an hundred natives, and among them four or five women, accompanied us on our march, and sold us a quantity of potatoes and a few fowls....We found the whole country strewed with stones of various sizes...which had indubitable marks of having been in a volcanic fire.... We reached the east side of the island, near a range of seven pillars or statues, of which only four remained standing, and one of them had lost its cap. They stood on a common pedestal, like those which we had seen on the other side, and its stones were square and fitted exactly in the same manner. Though the stone of which the statue itself is formed seems to be soft enough, being nothing but red tufa which covers the whole island, yet it was incomprehensible to me how such great masses could be formed by a set of people among whom we saw no tools; or raised and erected by them without machinery. The general appellation of this range was *Hanga Tebow; hanga* being the word which they prefix to every range. The names of the statues were *Ko-Tomoai, Ko-Tomoèeree, Ko-hòo-oo, Morahèena, Oomarèeva, Weenâboo, Weenapè.*

"From hence we continued our march to the northward along the sea, having a precipice on our right. The ground was the same ferruginous tufa...but after some time we came to a spot which was a single coherent rock or lump of black melted lava, which appeared to contain some iron. There was no soil, grass, or plant whatsoever upon it.

Beyond it we passed through a number of plantations of bananas, potatoes, and yams, and one of eddoes....

"The natives continued to offer some potatoes...and at a hut where we halted, they sold us some fish. Some of them carried arms, which were no other than the thin sticks we had seen before, and which were headed with a black vitreous lava, carefully wrapped in a small piece of cloth. Only one of them had a battle-axe resembling that of the New Zealanders, although much shorter. It had a head carved on each side, and a small round portion of the black glass...instead of eyes. They had likewise some small crooked human figures made of wood, of which we did not learn the use or signification....

"...we still advanced to the northward....Soon after the natives told us their *aree*, or *hareekee*, or king was coming toward us. Several men came on before him, and distributed sugar-canes to us all in sign of friendship, at the same time pronouncing the word *heeo*, which signifies friend. We now saw the king standing on a hill, and walked up to him, Mr. Pickersgill and myself making him some presents. We asked for his name, which he told us was Ko Toheetai, adding that he was *aree* or king. We were desirous of knowing whether he was the only chief of a district, or of the whole island; upon which he spread out his arms, as it were to include the whole island, and said *Waihu*. To shew that we understood him, we laid out hands on his breast, and calling him by name, added his title, king of *Waihu*, at which he expressed very great satisfaction, and conversed a great deal with his people on that subject. He was a middle age man, rather tall; his face and whole body strongly punctured. He wore a piece of cloth made of mulberry bark, quilted with threads of grass, and stained yellow with turmeric; and on his head he had a cap of long shining black feathers, which might be called a diadem.....

"When we wanted to continue our march he seemed to dislike it, and desired us to return, offering to accompany us; but seeing our officer determined to proceed...he desisted and went with us.

"We marched to an elevated spot, and stopped...to give Mr. Hodges time to draw some of the monuments, near one of which we found an entire skeleton of a man.....One of our sailors, who carried my plant bag, in which were a few nails, etc., being less careful of his bundle...a native snatched it up and ran off with it. None of us saw it, except Lieutenant Edgecumb, who immediately fired his musket, loaded with small shot, at the thief, and thus gave the alarm to us all. The native being wounded threw down the bag, which our people recovered, but he fell soon after; his countrymen took him up, and fled to a little distance, till we beckoned to them to return, which almost all of them did. Though this was the only instance of firing at a native during our stay at Easter Island, yet it is to be lamented that Europeans too often assume the power of inflicting punishments on people who are utterly unacquainted with their laws.

"From this spot we continued our march a good way inland, and were conducted to a deep well, which appeared to have been formed by art, and contained good fresh water, though somewhat troubled. We all drank heartily of it, and then went on, passing by several large statues, which had been overturned, till we came in sight of the two hummocks, near which we had perceived the greatest number of pillars or statues, from the ship, on the 12th. We mounted on an eminence in the neighborhood, from whence we beheld the sea on both sides of the island, across a plain which we had likewise discovered from the ship at that time. We viewed the whole eastern coast, and its numerous pillars, and were convinced that there was no bay or harbor on that side of the island. With this information we returned back to a large statue, which the natives called *Mangototo*, and in the shade of which we dined. In its neighborhood we met with another huge statue, which lay overturned; it was 27 feet long, and 9 feet in diameter, exceeding in magnitude every other pillar which we had seen on the island.

"In returning, we stopped once more at the well, and quenched our thirst, which the raging heat of the sun, reverberated from barren rocks, had excited. From hence we directed our march something nearer the ridge of hills which run along the middle of the island, but found the path more rugged and fatiguing than ever, the country being strewed with volcanic cinders, and desolate all round us, though we found many remaining proofs of its having been formerly cultivated."

At this point the group divided, going along different paths. Johann, along with Dr. Sparrman, a sailor and two natives, climbed to the summit-- with some difficulty due to Johann's infirmities. From here they could see the sea to the west, and the ship at anchor: "The hill was covered with a shrubbery of the *mimosa*, which grew here to the height of eight or nine feet, and some of whose stems near the root, were about the thickness of a man's thigh. We found another well hereabouts, of which the water was infected with a putrid taste and the smell of *hepar sulphuris*, but of which we drank, notwithstanding its nauseousness. The sun set very soon after we had left this well; so that we continued our walk downwards, for more than two hours entirely in the dark, during which my Indian's assistance was particularly valuable to me...."

We now return to George Forster's comments, who notes that : "...the most diligent enquiries on our part have not been sufficient to throw a clear light on the surprising objects which struck our eyes on this island. We may however attempt to account for those gigantic monuments, of which great numbers exist in every part; for as they are

so disproportionate to the present strength of the nation, it is most reasonable to look upon them as the remains of better times. The nicest calculations...never brought the number of inhabitants in this island beyond 700, who, destitute of tools, of shelter, and clothing, are obliged to spend all their time in providing food to support their precarious existence.... Accordingly we did not see a single instrument among them on all our excursions, which could have been of the least use in masonry or sculpture: We neither met with any quarries, where they had recently dug the materials, nor with unfinished statues which we might have considered as the work of the present race. It is therefore probable that these people were formerly more numerous, more opulent and happy, when they could spare sufficient time to flatter the vanity of their princes....It is not in our power to determine by what various accidents a nation so flourishing, could be reduced in number, and degraded to its present indigence."

Their great disappointment in the island as a place of refreshment is clear; the only article of value was sweet potatoes, but even they were few in number. They collected less than fifty fowls, and found the water to be ill-tasting and in short supply. He expresses surprise that the islanders generously shared their food, when obviously they were in need themselves. And once again he reiterates on the resemblance of culture, language, and government to that of the rest of Polynesia: "...[the language] being a dialect which, in many respects, resembles that of New Zealand, especially in the harshness of pronunciation and the use of gutturals, and yet, in other instances, partakes of that of Taheitee."

"The religion of the Easter Islanders is still wholly unknown to us, because abstract ideas are not to be acquired in so short a time as our stay. The statues, which are erected in honour of their kings, have a great affinity to the wooden figures, called *Tee*, [tiki] on the chief's *marai's* or burying places at Taheitee.... We are unacquainted with the amusements of the people...The disposition of these people is far from being warlike; their numbers are too inconsiderable, and their poverty too general, to create civil disturbances amongst them. It is equally improbable that they have foreign wars....This being premised, it is extraordinary that they should have different kinds of offensive weapons, and especially such as resemble those of the New Zeelanders; and we must add this circumstance to several others, which are inexplicable to us in their kind."

"Mahine frequently lamented their unhappy situation, and seemed to feel for them more than he had done for the New Zeelanders, because he found them much more destitute. He added another stick to the bundle which composed his journal, and remembered Easter Island with this observation, *tàta maïtaï, whennùa èene*, that the people were good, but the island very bad...."

[Von Saher is a retired businessman from the Netherlands. He lived and worked for ten years in Indonesia, becoming a consulant for tropical agriculture in South America and Africa. He authored a book about the first Dutchman to ever set foot on the island of Bali in 1597. In 1989 he made his first visit to Easter Island. He is writing a book on the prehistoric migrations of Austronesian-speaking peoples through East Asia to Polynesia.]

He rongo ho'ou:
What's New In Hangaroa.....

* The rescue-patrol launch "Tokerau" is now on the island. This unique launch is propelled by two Volvo engines and can reach a speed of 30 knots. It is expected to be indispensable in case of accidents in Rapa Nui waters and is in answer to demands by international carriers so that the airport can be used for international flights.

The tug that carried the Tokerau to the island also brought part of the infrastructure for the Chilean Navy base including eighteen housing modules which will be placed near Hanga Piko. Workers from the continent will be brought over to set up the pre-fabs.

* The new Naval base on the island has caused some suspicion among islanders. The base will have a contingent of Marines and, among other worries, islanders are concerned that the environment will be modified in a negative manner. The new commander of the naval station, Ricardo Menzel, said the buildings are of wood and thus it will fit in with the "island's ambience".

Naval personnel is said to consist of 12 persons, 14 marines, and 4 crew men for the Tokelau, the minimum needed, according to Governor Hey. [However, village rumors say some 700 will be stationed here!] The Governor noted that islanders have been complaining for years of too many continentals already on the island, and added that the presence of the Armada will facilitate problems of supply and transport.

Local islanders refer to the base as Estación Naval de Isla de Pascua; *El Mercurio* reports that suspicion and the "rejection of ideas" is the usual tendency of the Rapanui. Another project viewed with suspicion, according to *El Mercurio*, is the restoration of Tongariki by the Japanese firm, Tadano. [See below]

* The Navy will install a modern radio station to assure good communication with the continent, and they also are talking of a new pier.

* A "monumental" lighthouse will be constructed this year at the top of Rano Kau, equal to the one at Cape Horn; its light will be seen for miles in all directions. This structure will, according to reports in *El Mercurio*, "mark an important step in Chile's national sovereignty of Isla de Pascua". *[See Editorial, last page]*